

CONTINGENCY PLANNING

Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS) recognizes the importance of robust planning to ensure continuity of the educational mission for students and staff during potential short-term or long-term disruption to the educational environment. This policy provides guidance related to contingency planning documentation and activities.

A. Plan Contents. The contingency plan will:

1. Identify essential missions and functions and specify plans to maintain these missions and functions despite disruption, with as much operational continuity as feasible;
2. Meet desired contingency outcomes, including:
 - a. The wellness of LCPS students and employees,
 - b. Continuity of education, and
 - c. Compliance with Virginia Department of Education Standards of Learning, the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act, and other applicable federal, state, and local laws.
3. Provide recovery objectives, restoration priorities, and metrics;
4. Address contingency roles, and responsibilities and provide contact information for assigned individuals;
5. Address multiple disruption scenarios where school buildings may be closed, and virtual learning may be implemented, including, but not limited to:
 - a. District-wide total disruptions, such as a pandemic, earthquake, or other disaster rendering in-person instruction non-viable at all school locations,
 - b. Single school total disruptions, such as a fire or other disaster rendering in-person instruction non-viable at a single school location,
 - c. Partial disruptions at one or more schools, including district-wide, for which instruction may be viable at one or more school locations, but with modifications required, such as social distancing, and
 - d. Inclement weather disruption.
6. Address eventual, full return to operations; and
7. Be approved by the Superintendent.

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- B. Plan Coordination. Contingency plan development and planning activities will include organizational elements with a role to play in plan execution and/or a responsibility for related plans, such as the Public Information Office's role in emergency communications.
- C. Training. Key contingency personnel will be trained consistent with assigned roles and responsibilities within 30 days of assuming a key contingency role or responsibility; when needed based on changes to the contingency plan; and/or at least annually.
- D. Exercises. The plan will be tested at least annually to determine its effectiveness and LCPS' readiness to execute the plan. The contingency plan will be improved, as needed, based on lessons learned during these exercises or tests.
- E. Plan Maintenance and Reviews. The contingency plan will be reviewed at least annually to address changes in the organization or organizational environment and updated, as needed. Key components and changes should be communicated to the School Board.
- F. Plan Distribution. When developed and whenever substantively modified, the plan will be distributed to key personnel with a role in the contingency plan, including the Superintendent, Chief of Staff, and Cabinet.

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Cross Ref: Policy [3070](#), Safety- and Emergency-Related Communications